

Move for Better Blood Sugar

A take-home guide for older adults managing Type 2 diabetes

Why move?	Safe ways to start
Regular physical activity can help many people manage blood sugar, support heart health, improve mood and sleep, maintain strength, and protect balance and independence.	Start slowly. Try a 5-10 minute walk, seated marching, arm raises, toe taps, dancing, or light household movement. Choose activities you enjoy and can do safely.

Safety Reminders

- Ask your healthcare team which activities are safe for you before starting or changing your routine.
- Wear comfortable, supportive shoes and check your feet before and after activity.
- Drink water. Avoid exercising in extreme heat or cold.
- If you use insulin or certain diabetes medicines, ask whether you should check blood glucose before, during, or after activity.
- Stop and ask for help if you have chest pain, severe shortness of breath, dizziness, or sudden weakness.

Simple Chair Routine

Move	Try
Seated marching	30-60 seconds
Arm raises	8-10 slow raises
Toe taps	30-60 seconds
Shoulder rolls	5 forward, 5 backward
Optional sit-to-stand	3-5 times, only if steady and safe

My Movement Plan for This Week

This week I will try:	
For this many minutes:	
On these days:	
Who or what can help me remember?	

Remember: Small movement still counts. Start where you are, build slowly, and choose safe activities that fit your life.

Sources: CDC Get Active; CDC Older Adult Activity; NIDDK Healthy Living with Diabetes; American Diabetes Association fitness guidance.